

Task-5

Part-A: Case Study

The Crime: Phishing

Phishing is a form of digital fraud where attackers masquerade as a trusted entity—such as a bank, a government agency, or a popular service provider—to steal credentials, financial data, or personal identification. Unlike traditional hacking, which targets software vulnerabilities, phishing targets human psychology.

How It Happens:

Step-by-Step

1. Preparation: The attacker creates a deceptive email, text (smishing), or website that mimics a legitimate organization's branding.
2. The Hook: A mass message is sent out with an "urgent" call to action, such as "Your account has been compromised" or "Update your payment details immediately."
3. The Redirection: The victim clicks a malicious link that directs them to a spoofed login page designed to look identical to the real site.
4. The Theft: As the victim enters their username and password, the attacker captures the data in real-time.
5. The Exploitation: The attacker uses these credentials to drain bank accounts, sell the data on the dark web, or launch further attacks within a professional network.

Target Audience and Consequences

While anyone can be a target, attackers often focus on vulnerable populations, such as the elderly, or employees in high-access roles like HR and Finance. The consequences are devastating: victims face identity theft, ruined credit scores, and total financial loss. For organizations, a single successful phishing attempt

can lead to massive data breaches, legal liabilities, and irreparable damage to brand reputation.